

Title of Lab exercise-V: Group Discussion (GD), Rules and Regulations, Do's and Don'ts and Evaluation of GD

Objective of the exercise: To learn to participate in group discussion effectively.

Preamble of the exercise: Group discussion primarily involves exchange of thoughts, opinions, concerns, ideas, ideas and associated feelings through verbal and non-verbal group communication in a structured way. It is a useful tool for problem solving, decision-making, and personality assessment. GD abilities may ensure academic success, popularity, and a favourable employment offer. Thus, it is critical to be able to participate in a GD effectively and confidently. Participants should be able to talk confidently, demonstrate leadership qualities, and motivate the group to attain its goals.

General Procedure for the conduct of group discussion:

1. Group formation (selectively or based on some criterions)
2. Topic selection
3. Panel for evaluation comprised of technical or/and HR experts.
4. General rules like time limits and panel expectations are explained sometimes.
5. Initial introduction about the topic may be given by panel members and expected to continue the discussions thereon by group members.
6. Panel may offer some time to discuss about the strategy and content of the discussion.
7. Panel does not interfere with the discussion but only observe every group member for the selection process.
8. Discussion continues till panel signals the termination of the discussion.
9. Depending upon the status of discussion panel may extend or cut down the time of discussion run time.
10. Summing up the discussion is also expected optionally based on the topics and the quality of discussion.

It is important to understand the difference between GD and debate. Debate is a competitive activity, but group discussion is a cooperative group process. In a debate, a speaker can talk 'for' or 'against' an issue, whereas in a GD, the speaker can do both.

Common Recommendations to success /get noticed during group discussion:

1. Try to be a team member /exhibit team playing skills
2. Understand the other's person point of view
3. Ensure team reaches to common agreement where everyone in the team agrees.
4. Participate with in depth subject knowledge related to the point of discussion. The greater your knowledge of the subject, the more enthusiastic and confident you will be during the discussion.
5. Put forth your idea /opinion/solution upfront without any hesitation (backed by evidence).
6. Substantiate your views with sample case study. Your approach to the case study will be observed keenly by the evaluators.
7. Communicate with an adequate expression.
8. Practice Listening skill dominantly towards stated purpose of the discussion.
9. Communicate with utmost clarity of thoughts.
10. Use an apt respectful language and body language (though you disagree to the points being discussed)
11. Practice an appropriate approach of leadership which expect not too aggressive and submissive but more leaned towards democratic.
12. Try to adopt role/roles from the following as per capacity and willingness

Initiator /Information seeker and giver / Procedure facilitator / Opinion seeker/giver / Clarifier / Summarizer / Social supporter /Harmonizer / Tension reliever / Energizer /Attacker /moderator/ Dominator.

Apart from these guidelines, other tips include:

- Speaking is important; do not sit silently. Speak freely.
- Do not monopolize the conversation or talk too much.
- Give everyone a chance to speak.
- Maintain eye contact with everyone in the group.
- Show active listening skills.
- Do not interrupt anyone while they are speaking.
- Keep the topic on track and don't be irrelevant.
- Encourage someone who is silent to talk.

- Do not argue with anyone.
- Do not debate with anyone, while the group looks on.
- Do not repeat what has been said, be attentive; try to develop on ideas expressed or give out new ideas.
- Clarify your doubts and then proceed.
- Be brief.
- Do not commit grammatical errors while talking.

Guidelines for the conduct of the exercise:

1. This exercise to be performed in group.
2. Appropriate group formation and selection of an appropriate topic helps in practicing GD skills.
3. Demonstrate/exemplify the learned GD skills in a group.
4. When one group is performing GD, ask other group to evaluate or observe the activity with their recommendation to improve.
5. Summarize the learning and outcome of this exercise with an appropriate brief writeup with above mentioned guideline points.

CO-PO Mapping strength and Justification:

CO	PO	CO-PO mapping strength	Mapping Justification
Participate in the group discussion and evaluate the same	PO 09	3	Exercise to learn and demonstrate the group discussion supports in team building and leadership (PO 09), ability to communicate effectively (PO 10) and ability to maintain and strengthen professional and personal relationship throughout work tenure (PO 12) and collaborative decision making by building strong consensus. This justifies strong mapping with PO 09, PO 10 and PO 12.
	PO 10	3	
	PO 12	3	

Evaluation Guidelines/Parameters:

1. Individual focused evaluation through group activity.
2. Understanding and practicing Do's and Don'ts for effective group discussion.
3. Demonstration of the effectivity in GD participation.
4. Brief report on student's exercise.

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